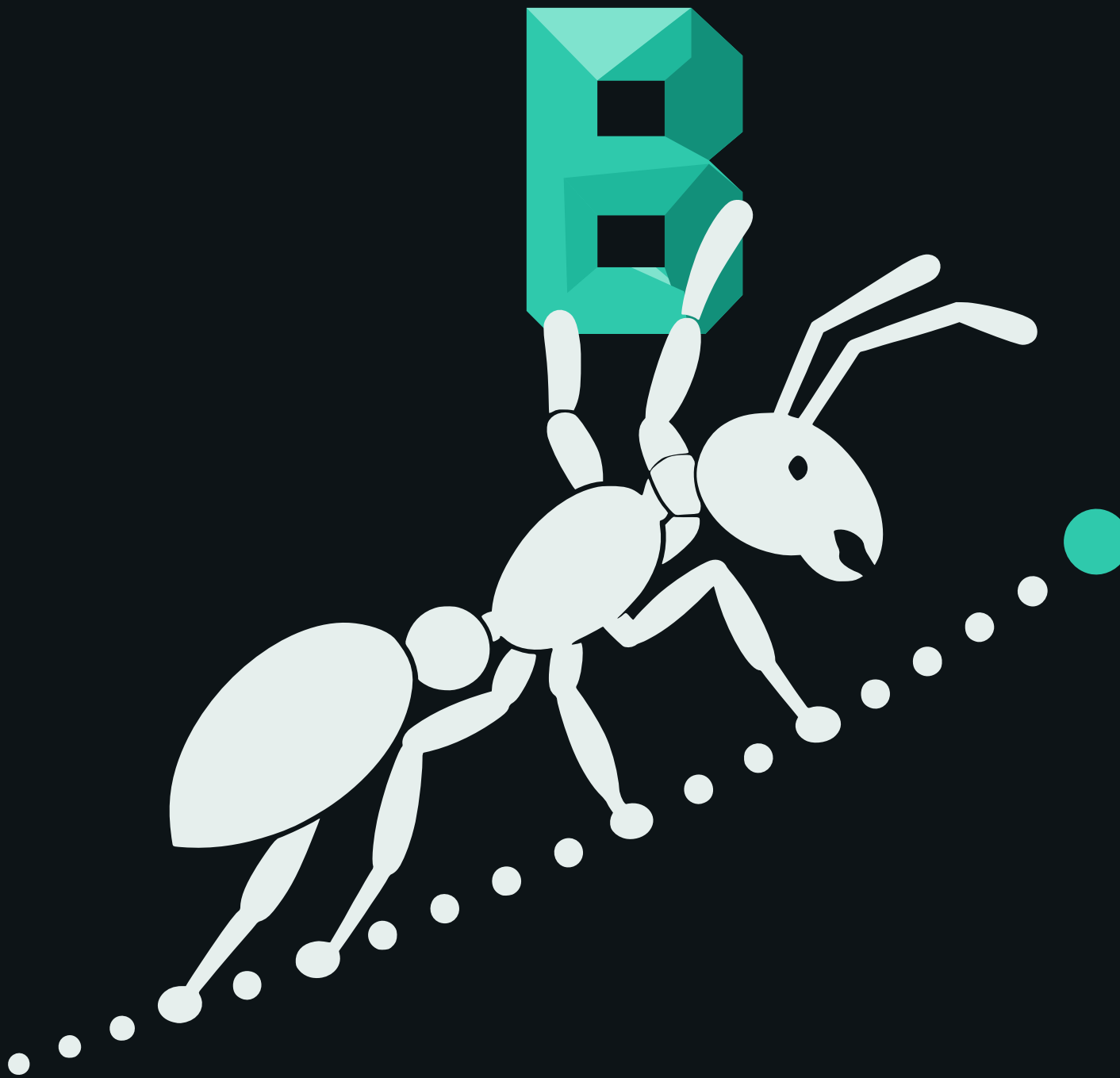


BRAND SYSTEM • VERSION 1.0 • OCTOBER 2026

bandwise

Small model. Heavy lifting.
It knows how sure it is.

Logo • Color • Type • Voice • Motion • Components • Tokens



bandwise knows how sure it is.

A small, fast model takes the routine calls. Every answer carries a band, a reason and a cost. Sure answers ship. Shaky ones come to a person.

The brand is an ant because an ant carries many times its own weight, and because it leaves a trail the colony can follow. Carry is the strength. Trail is the proof. Both ideas live in one system.

PROMISE

You always know how much to trust it.

PERSONALITY

Calm. Candid. Street-smart. A tool crib, stamped labels, a load rating on a hook.

AUDIENCE

Dev teams running AI in production, who want a number instead of a vibe.

THE WEDGE

Confidence as a first-class output. High ships, Medium gets evidence, Low goes to you.

Where this comes from

Built from DJ's identity directions (Carry, Trail, Chamber), the ant marks Nick approved, and the voice from the interview: calm, candid, street-smart.

KEPT FROM A • CARRY

The idea (a small model lifting a heavy decision), the confidence ruler, the stamped-label voice, Archivo Expanded headlines, JetBrains Mono for data, and the motion: the ant walks the ruler and sets the load at the score.

KEPT FROM B • TRAIL

The trail motif, bright teal on dark (#4FD1B5), the dark-first console, the "band, reason, receipt" answer shape, and Schibsted Grotesk for body text.

KEPT FROM C • CHAMBER

The explainability: each band has a job and a name. Used for teaching and docs, not as a visual style. The moss and gold are dropped.

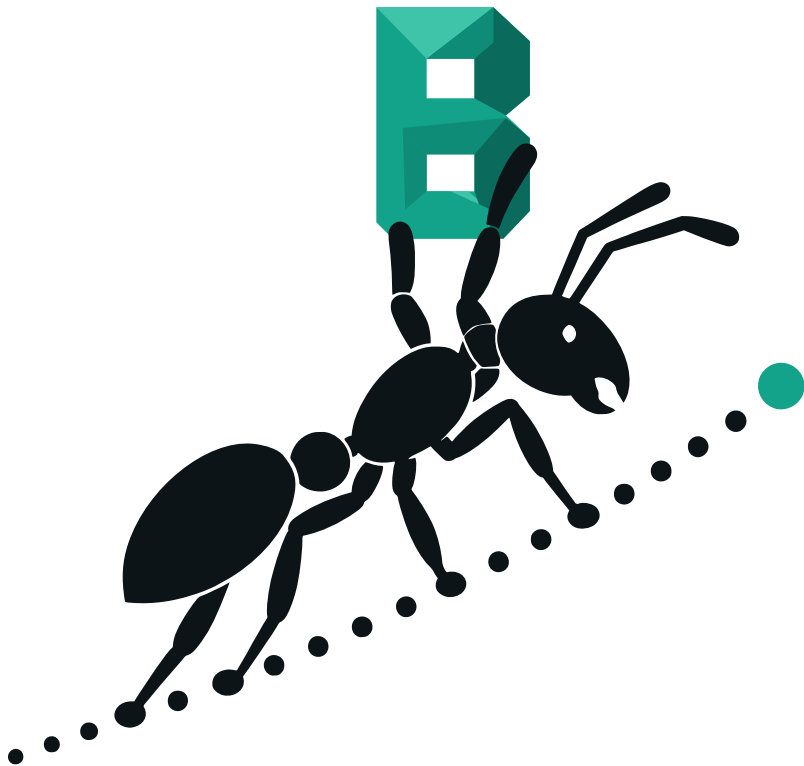
CHANGED

The palette is cool. DJ's A and B used bone paper, soil and a coral dark-mode red. Those sit close to Anthropic's clay, so they are out. Ink, cool white and teal replace them. The alert red is a cool crimson. Nothing orange, rust, clay or cream.

ADDED

Violet for Medium, so three bands read as three colors with no amber. Plus paired type, design tokens, components and a handoff file set, so the system can be built in Claude.

Two marks, one block



A • ASCENT

Primary. The ant climbs the trail with the B. Use wherever there is room: site hero, docs cover, decks, social, print.



C • SCOUT

Square and compact. The ant holds the B overhead, facing us. App icon, avatar, stickers, empty states, anything symmetric or square.



B • THE BLOCK

Monogram. The faceted B alone. Favicon, small UI, anything under 56px.

A and C are approved and final. They share one B, the same shape at the same size: four flat teal tones, two true counters. The ant bodies are traced AI art. Do not redraw them; always use the supplied files.

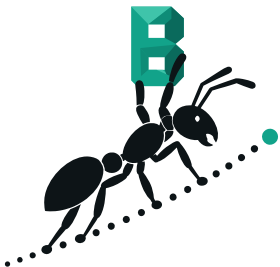
Lockups



HORIZONTAL · A (PRIMARY)



HORIZONTAL · C (COMPACT)



STACKED · A



STACKED · C

Lockups on dark



HORIZONTAL · A (PRIMARY)



HORIZONTAL · C (COMPACT)



STACKED · A



STACKED · C

Clear space and minimum sizes

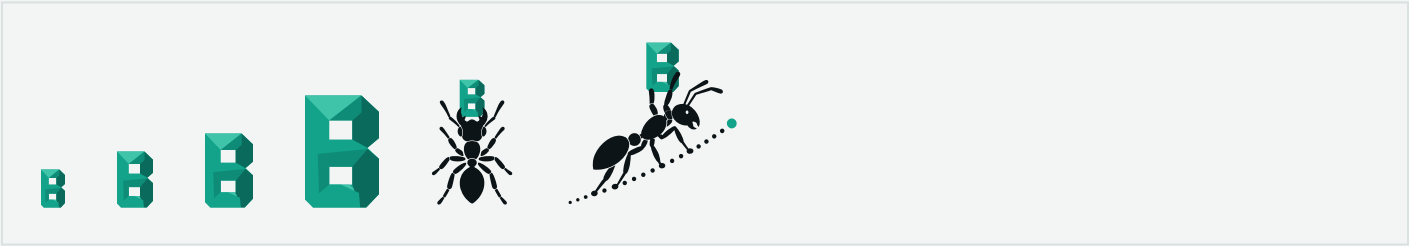


Clear space = half the height of the B block on all sides, measured from the B in the lockup. Nothing enters that area: no text, edge, image or other logo.

The wordmark is always lowercase and always sits with the ant (A or C). Lockups are fixed: the wordmark's capital height is about 1/4 of the mark height in horizontal lockups. Never rescale the parts separately, and never set the wordmark alone.

ASSET	MIN SCREEN	MIN PRINT
Horizontal lockup, A or C	160px wide	40mm
Stacked lockup	96px high	28mm
Mark A (no wordmark)	72px wide	20mm
Mark C (no wordmark)	56px high	16mm
B block monogram	16px	5mm

Below these sizes, switch to the B block. The ant's thin legs and antennae fill in first; the B carries identity at small sizes.



Logo don'ts



Do not stretch or squash



Do not rotate or tilt



Do not recolor



No shadows, glows or outlines



Do not fade or lower contrast



Do not crop the mark



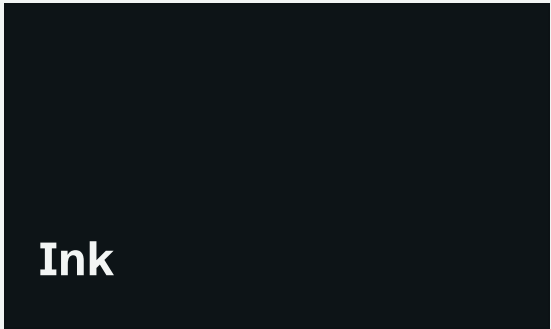
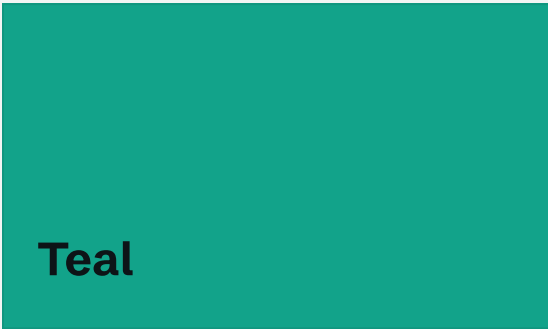
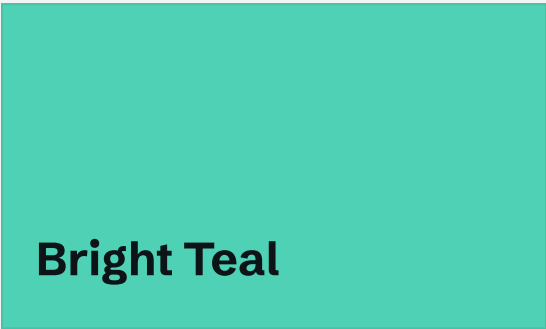
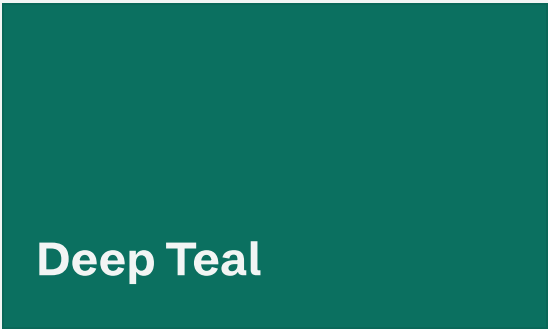
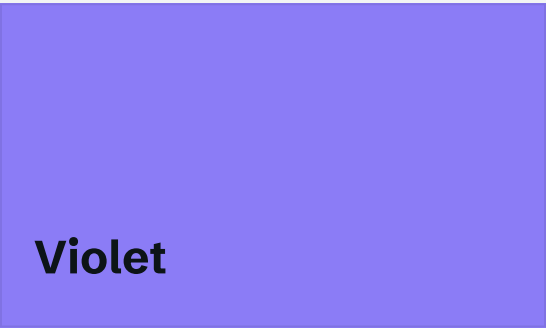
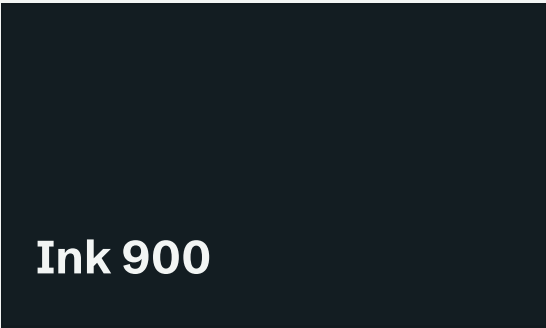
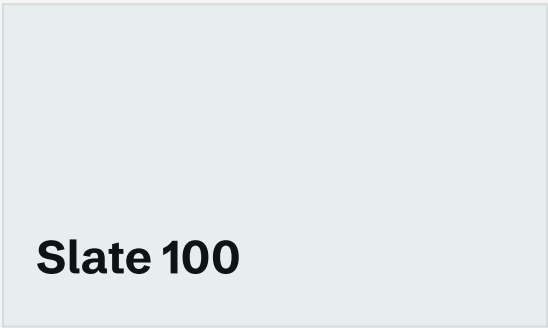
Do not blur or distort



Do not grey out the B

Also: do not redraw, trace or "improve" the ant. Do not swap the B for another letter. Do not set the mark on photos or busy patterns without a solid ink or cool-white panel behind it. Do not use warm backgrounds (cream, tan, orange, rust, clay).

Palette

 Ink #0D1417 Text, dark ground	 Cool White #F2F5F4 Page ground	 Teal #12A38A Brand fill, HIGH	 Bright Teal #4FD1B5 Brand on dark	 Deep Teal #0B7060 Brand text on light
 Slate #5B6B70 Muted text	 Violet #8B7CF6 MEDIUM band	 Alert Red #D92D4A LOW band, errors	 Ink 900 #131D22 Dark surface	 Slate 100 #E8EEED Light sunken



NEUTRAL RAMP • 950 / 900 / 800 / 700 / 600 / 400 / 300 / 200 / 100 / 50

Teal does most of the work. Violet and red separate the bands and signal errors; keep them under 10% of any screen. Every neutral leans cool. No warm neutrals, no pure black (#000), no pure grey.

Roles in light and dark

TOKEN	LIGHT	DARK	USE
--bw-bg	 #F2F5F4	 #0D1417	Page ground
--bw-surface	 #FFFFFF	 #131D22	Cards, panels, inputs
--bw-text	 #0D1417	 #F2F5F4	Body and headings
--bw-text-muted	 #5B6B70	 #8A9A9F	Secondary text, captions
--bw-border	 #D9E1E1	 #2A3A41	Hairlines and dividers
--bw-brand	 #12A38A	 #4FD1B5	Fills, graphics, primary button
--bw-brand-text	 #0B7060	 #4FD1B5	Links and brand-colored text
--bw-medium	 #8B7CF6	 #8B7CF6	Medium band fill. Text on light: #5B4BD6
--bw-low	 #D92D4A	 #FF6B83	Low band fill, errors. Text on light: #C4203D
--bw-focus	 #5B4BD6	 #4FD1B5	Focus ring, 2px, 2px offset

Rule of thumb: teal #12A38A is too light for text on white (2.9:1). On light, brand text is Deep Teal. A teal button carries ink text, not white (5.9:1).

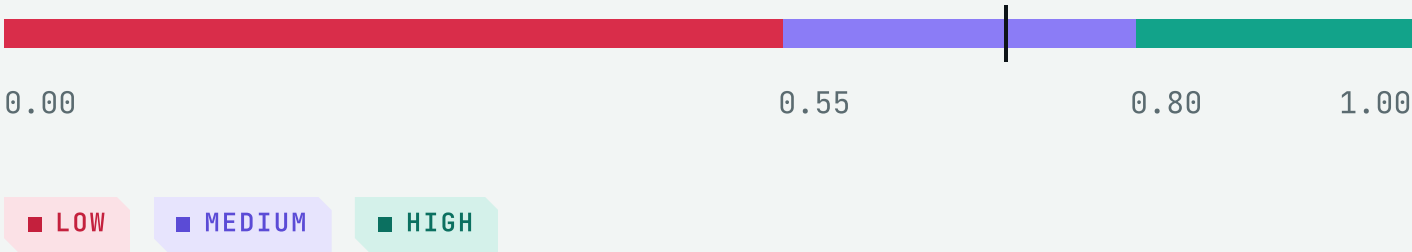
Contrast, checked

Aa Ink on Cool White 16.9:1 • AAA	Aa Slate on Cool White 5.1:1 • AA	Aa Deep Teal on Cool White 5.5:1 • AA	Aa Ink on Teal 5.9:1 • AA
Aa Violet 600 on Cool White 5.6:1 • AA	Aa Red 600 on Cool White 5.3:1 • AA	Aa White on Alert Red 4.8:1 • AA	Aa Cool White on Ink 16.9:1 • AAA
Aa Bright Teal on Ink 9.8:1 • AAA	Aa Slate 400 on Ink 6.4:1 • AA	Aa Violet on Ink 5.6:1 • AA	Aa Red 300 on Ink 6.8:1 • AA

WCAG 2.x relative-luminance ratios. Avoid: Teal #12A38A as text on white (2.9:1), Violet #8B7CF6 as text on white (3.0:1), white text on Teal (3.2:1). Never rely on color alone: bands always carry a label (HIGH, MEDIUM, LOW) and a number.

Bands: the color system's job

Color in the product means one thing: how sure bandwise is. Three bands, three colors, three actions.



BAND	SCORE	ACTION	SAY
■ HIGH	≥ 0.80	Ship	"Strong trail. Shipping it."
■ MEDIUM	0.55–0.79	Get evidence	"Not done yet."
■ LOW	< 0.55	Ask a person	"Faint trail. Kicking it to you."

Thresholds are product defaults (0.55 and 0.80, from DJ's Carry direction). Teams can move them. The colors do not change.

Paired type

DISPLAY · ARCHIVO EXPANDED

Aa

Archivo, width 125%, weight 800. Headlines, the wordmark, big numbers. Stamped steel: wide, heavy, plain. Tracking -0.02em. Sentence case, never all caps.

BODY · SCHIBSTED GROTESK

Aa

Schibsted Grotesk, 400 / 500 / 600. Paragraphs, UI labels, buttons, tables. A quiet grotesk that stays readable at 14px and keeps the display face loud by contrast.

DATA · JETBRAINS MONO

0.71

JetBrains Mono, 400 / 500 / 600. Scores, costs, IDs, code, labels (uppercase, +0.08em). Tabular figures. Anything bandwise measured is set in mono.

Small model.
Heavy lifting.

bandwise puts a small, fast model on the routine calls and tells you how sure it was.

0.71 · \$0.00003 · saved ~\$0.004

All three are open-licensed (OFL) Google Fonts. Archivo Expanded is DJ's Carry headline face; Schibsted Grotesk is DJ's Trail body face. Fallbacks: Helvetica Neue, Arial, ui-monospace.

Type scale

Display
64 / 1.04

Know which answers to trust

H1
48 / 1.08

Every decision leaves a trail

H2
36 / 1.12

Not done yet.

H3
24 / 1.2

Medium • 0.71

H4
18 / 1.3

7 tests in auth/ regressed

Body
16 / 1.55

The sure ones ship. The shaky ones come to you.

Small
14 / 1.5

Used in tables, helper text, dense UI.

Label
12 / 1.4

BAND • WHY • COST

Base 16px, line height 1.55 for reading, 1.04 to 1.2 for display. Prose max 68ch. Tabular numbers wherever a score or cost appears.

Type in use

DECISION • AUTH/SESSION-REFRESH

Not done yet.

BAND

MEDIUM

 0.71

WHY 7 tests in auth/ regressed

COST \$0.00003 • saved ~\$0.004

RULE	DETAIL
Headlines	Archivo Expanded 800, sentence case, -0.02em, 2 lines max
One display per view	Two competing headlines flatten the hierarchy
Numbers	Always mono, tabular, never rounded for show
Labels	Mono 12px, uppercase, +0.08em, muted
Links	Deep Teal (light) or Bright Teal (dark); underline on hover
Never	All-caps display, italic display, white text on teal, gradient text

Space, shape and the chamfer

SPACING · 4PX BASE

- 1 · 4px
- 2 · 8px
- 3 · 12px
- 4 · 16px
- 5 · 24px
- 6 · 32px
- 7 · 48px
- 8 · 64px

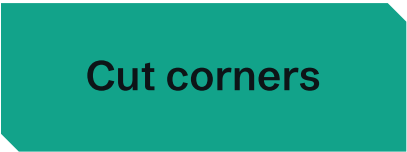
RADIUS · SMALL, FACETED



0 · 2 · 4 · 8px. Pills for chips and toggles only.

Flat surfaces, 1px hairlines. Shadow only on overlays (menus, dialogs), one soft layer.

THE CHAMFER · THE B'S SIGNATURE



Two corners cut at 45° (top-right and bottom-left): 8px on buttons and cards, 6px on badges, echoing the facets of the B. One chamfered element per region; secondary elements stay square.

Grid: 12 columns, 24px gutters, 1200px content max. Breakpoints 640 / 960 / 1280. Touch targets 44px minimum; default control height 40px.

Icons and the trail

ICONS · LUCIDE (ISC LICENSE) AT 1.5PX STROKE


check


x


triangle-alert


arrow-up-right


search

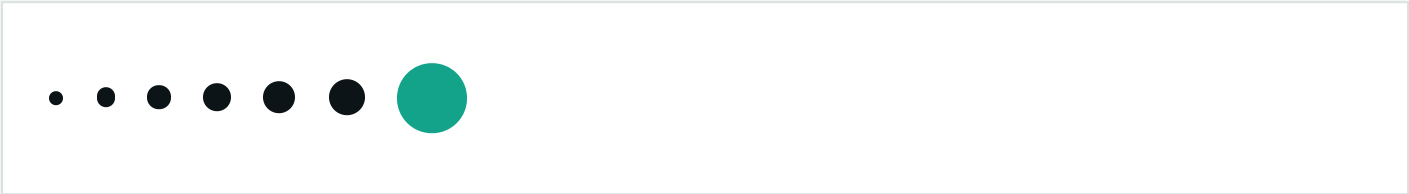

settings


user


shield-check

Use Lucide as the base set: 24px grid, 1.5px stroke, round caps, currentColor. It stays quiet so the marks stay loud. Icons take band colors only when they are the band.

THE TRAIL MOTIF



A trail of dots that grows toward one teal node, taken from mark A. Use it as a divider, a progress track, a loading state and a quiet decorative line. Dots in ink or border color, one teal node at the end, round dots only, gap about twice the dot diameter.

```
.....  
.bw-trail { border-top: 3px dotted var(--bw-border-strong) }
```

Voice

Calm, candid, street-smart. bandwise talks like a good foreman: it states what is true, gives the number, and says when it does not know.

CALM

Lead with the state. "Not done yet." No alarm, no hype, no exclamation marks. Bad news gets the same tone as good news.

CANDID

Say what it cost and what it doesn't know. "We don't know. A person should look." Never imply certainty the model does not have.

STREET-SMART

Plain words, a little edge. "Faint trail. Kicking it to you." Short sentences, concrete nouns, the odd trade-shop image.

SAMPLE LINES

- Small model. Heavy lifting.
- Not done yet. 7 tests in auth/ regressed.
- This check cost three thousandths of a cent.
- Strong trail. Shipping it.
- We don't know. A person should look.

THE FOUR-PART ANSWER

Every result reads in this order: **state** (one sentence), **band** (with the number), **why** (one fact), **cost** (in dollars, to the right digit). Nothing else is required. Nothing ornamental is allowed.

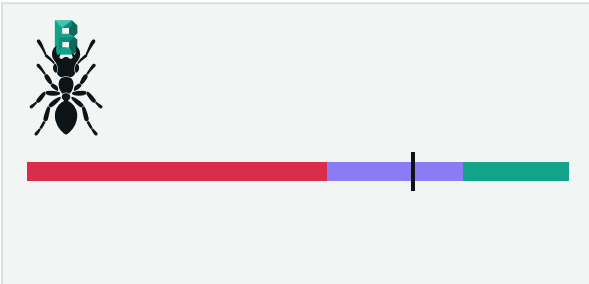
Copy rules

DO	DON ' T	WHERE	WRITE
Name the band and the number	"High confidence!" with no number	Primary button	"Ship it" · "Review 3 decisions"
Short sentences, active verbs	Stacked clauses, passive hedges	Empty state	"Nothing on the trail yet. Run your first check."
"Ship", "check", "ask a person"	"Leverage", "unlock", "supercharge", "seamless"	Error	"Couldn't reach the model. Nothing shipped. Retry."
Say what it cost, to the digit	"Pennies", "affordable", "cost-effective"	Low band	"Faint trail. This one is yours."
"We don't know."	"Oops! Something went wrong."	Success toast	"Shipped. 0.91 · \$0.00002."
Sentence case everywhere	Title Case Headlines, ALL CAPS display	Docs intro	"bandwise tells you how sure it was. Here is how to read it."
Plain punctuation, regular dashes	Emoji, exclamation marks, em dashes	Name	Always lowercase "bandwise", everywhere, even at the start of a sentence. The wordmark always sits with the ant.

Keep the product terms fixed across UI, docs and sales copy: High / Medium / Low; ship / get evidence / ask a person. Full rules in BRAND-VOICE.md.

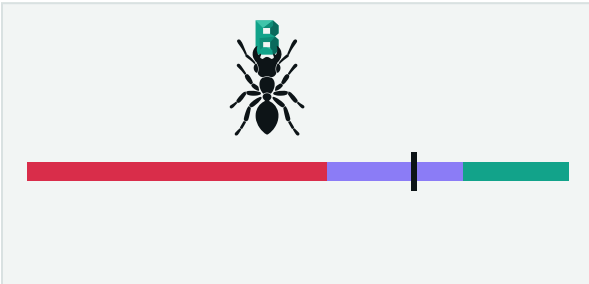
Motion: the ant walks the trail

Purposeful, not constant. Motion happens when a decision resolves. The ant walks the ruler, stops at the score, and sets the load down.



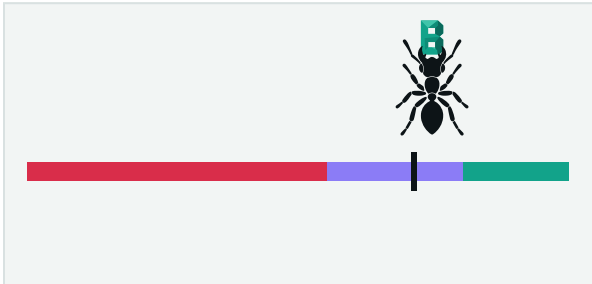
1 · START · 0 MS

The ant waits at 0.00 with the B. The ruler is idle.



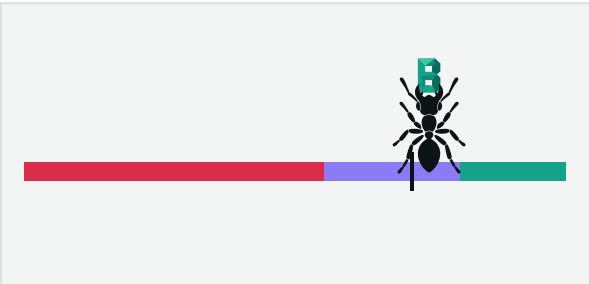
2 · WALK · 0-1400 MS

Steady walk along the ruler, ease-walk. The B stays level.



3 · STOP · AT THE SCORE

The ant stops at 0.71. The band lights up (violet, Medium).



4 · SET DOWN · +480 MS

The B lowers onto the band with one small overshoot. Score and cost fade in.

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
dur-fast	140ms	Hover, focus, small state
dur-base	240ms	Menus, tabs, toasts
dur-walk	1400ms	Ant crossing the ruler
ease-settle	.34, 1.4, .64, 1	Load set-down only

Rules. One moving thing per view. No looping idle animation, no parallax, no bounce on UI chrome. With prefers-reduced-motion, the ant appears at the score with the B already set down and durations go to 0. Concept storyboard uses the approved C art; final animation needs the ant's limbs separated (see handoff). Playable concept: [bandwise-motion-demo.html](#).

Buttons and inputs

BUTTONS • STATES

VARIANT	DEFAULT	HOVER	DISABLED
Primary	Ship it	Ship it	Ship it
Secondary	Review	Review	Review
Ghost	Details	Details	Details
Danger	Revoke key	Revoke key	Revoke key

Focus: 2px ring in --bw-focus, 2px offset, on every interactive element. Pressed: 1px down.
Height 40px; 32px compact; 48px touch.

INPUTS

API KEY NAME

prod-router

Default. Lowercase, dashes ok.

THRESHOLD • HIGH BAND

0.80

Focus. Teams can move the line.

THRESHOLD • LOW BAND

0.95

Error. Low must sit below Medium. Try 0.55.

Bands, alerts, tables, tabs

BADGES

■ HIGH · 0.91

■ MEDIUM · 0.71

■ LOW · 0.38

ALERTS

Shipped.

0.91 · \$0.00002

Not done yet.

7 tests in auth/ regressed.

Nothing shipped.

Couldn't reach the model. Retry.

TABS

Decisions

Lanes

Budget

Receipts

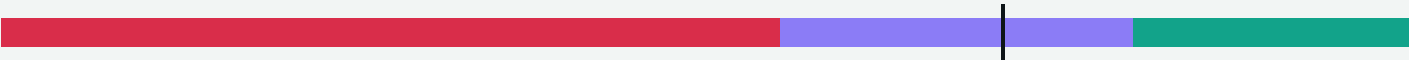
TABLE

DECISION	BAND	SCORE	COST
auth/session-refresh	■ MEDIUM	0.71	\$0.00003
docs/typo-sweep	■ HIGH	0.94	\$0.00001
billing/proration	■ LOW	0.38	\$0.00004

CODE

```
bandwise check --lane auto
band    medium · 0.71
why     7 tests in auth/ regressed
cost    $0.00003
```

CONFIDENCE RULER



App icon and favicon



APP ICON · DARK · 1024

Scout on ink. Full-bleed square; the OS adds the mask.



APP ICON · LIGHT

Scout on cool white, for light OS themes.



FAVICON · THE BLOCK

B on an ink tile. SVG, 16 / 32 / 48 PNG, ICO.



ACTUAL SIZE · 16 / 32 / 48 / 64

The B stays legible at 16px. The ant does not, so it never goes below 56px.

Avatar and social



AVATAR • DARK • 512

Scout, centered with margin so round crops keep the whole ant.



AVATAR • LIGHT

For light-mode platforms.



OPEN GRAPH • 1200×630

Ascent plus the line. Dark and light versions.



PROFILE HEADER • 1500×500

Usage: do and don't

DO

- Lead with ink and cool white. Let teal carry attention.
- Show the band, the number and the cost together.
- Use the supplied SVGs. Keep the B identical in A and C.
- Pair Archivo Expanded headlines with Schibsted body and mono data.
- Use one chamfered element per region.
- Tie motion to a decision resolving.
- Pass AA on every text and background pair.

DON'T

- Use warm tones: cream, tan, clay, coral, orange, rust. The palette is cool by design.
- Use teal text on white, or white text on teal.
- Use color alone to show a band.
- Redraw, warp or recolor the ant.
- Add gradients, glows, stock photos or ant clip art.
- Write hype: "powerful", "AI-powered", "revolutionary".
- Loop idle animations or add sound.

Build the design system

Built to become a design system in Claude. Give Claude the files below; it reads the tokens and rules, then builds components from them.

FILE	WHAT IT IS
DESIGN.md	Rules for Claude: tokens, components, do and don't
BRAND-VOICE.md	Voice rules, word lists, UI copy patterns
bandwise-tokens.json	All tokens, design-token format
bandwise-tokens.css	CSS variables, light and dark
bandwise-components.css	Reference components
logo, icon, social files	SVG masters, PNGs, favicon, app icon, avatar

HOW TO WIRE IT UP

1. Add the files to the repo or the Claude project (a /brand folder works).
2. Load the three Google Fonts (Archivo with the width axis, Schibsted Grotesk, JetBrains Mono).
3. Import bandwise-tokens.css once at the root; set data-theme to light or dark.
4. Build every component on the --bw-* semantic tokens only, never raw hex.
5. Point Claude at DESIGN.md and ask it to build components from it.

STILL OPEN

Violet for Medium is a proposal; swap two tokens if you prefer another cool hue. Band thresholds (0.55, 0.80) come from DJ's page. Final ant animation needs the ant's limbs separated from the traced art.